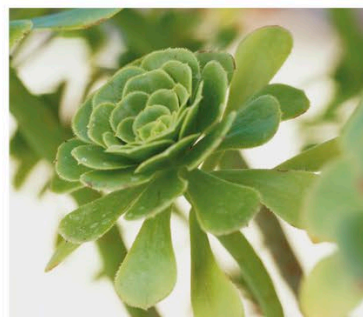




Plants for architectural foliage

The large, shapely leaves of a tree or shrub create features that can equal the dramatic impact of the brightest, most colorful flowers.

Use plants with sculptural foliage as a focal point at the end of a path or as gatekeepers to guard an entranceway. Many big-leaved species prefer shady locations, where a group with foliage of different sizes, shapes, and textures will produce an elegant scheme that sings out from the gloom. In sunny sites, spiked-plants and sword-shaped leaves to draw the eye—their dramatic outlines create an effective contrast to rounded and small, tear-shaped foliage. Some trees and shrubs, including Indian bean tree, should be pruned hard in late winter to encourage young stems that bear the largest leaves.



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aeonium arboreum

TREE AEONIU Grow this tender evergreen perennial in a pot and stand it outside in summer to enjoy its rosettes of fleshy, pale green spoon-shaped leaves, purple-black in some forms, which appear on branching stems. Overwinter under cover.

↑↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z9–11



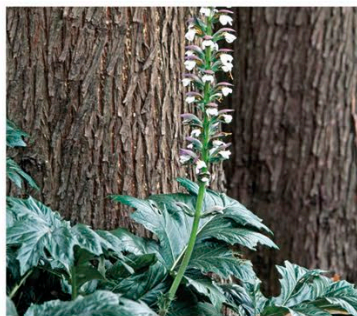
TREE LARGE

Araucaria araucana

MONKEY PUZZLE This evergreen conifer, suitable for large gardens, has an unusual branching, open habit. Its stems are densely clothed in scalelike, prickly green leaves, giving it a sculptural quality. Slow-growing at first, it grows rapidly after a few years.

↑80ft (25m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀ Z7–11



PERENNIAL LARGE

Acanthus mollis

COMMON BEAR'S BREECHES This upright semievergreen perennial, with its deeply cut, glossy dark green leaves, lends an architectural note to sunny and shaded gardens. Tall spikes of funnel-shaped, white and purple flower heads form in summer.

↑4ft (1.2m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z7–11



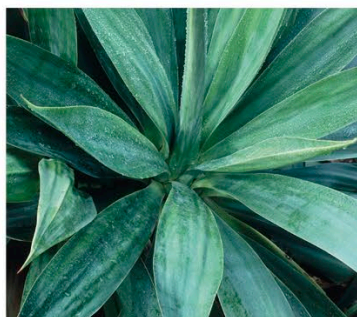
PERENNIAL LARGE

Actaea simplex

BUGBANE An upright perennial, grown for its divided, dark green sculptural foliage. From early- to mid-fall, it produces arching stems of bottlebrush, off-white-tinged purple flowers. 'Brunette' (above) is a dark purple-leaved variety.

↑4ft (2m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z4–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Beschorneria yuccoides

MEXICAN LILY Ideal for a container of gritty soil-based potting mix, this evergreen perennial has pointed, fleshy gray-green strap-shaped leaves, creating a sculptural focal point. Yellow-green tubular flowers, with red bracts, may form in summer.

↑↔5ft (1.5m)

☀ Z9–11 (N)



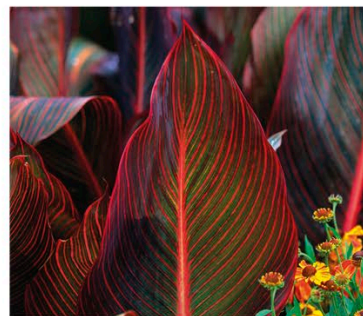
PERENNIAL LARGE

Calamagrostis x acutiflora

FEATHER REED GRASS The fountain of long, arching green leaves produced by this clump-forming deciduous grass offers architectural interest for most of the year. The tall bronze summer flower heads fade to buff. Cut back in early spring.

↑6ft (1.8m) ↔4ft (1.2m)

☀ Z5–9



PERENNIAL LARGE

Canna tropicanna

CANNA Grown for its large paddle-shaped foliage, this perennial offers a spectacular display of orange and dark green, striped leaves, creating a sculptural focal point. In late summer, tall stems topped with ruffled orange flowers appear.

↑5½ft (1.6m) ↔20in (50cm)

☀ Z7–11



TREE LARGE

Catalpa bignonioides

INDIAN BEAN TREE This spreading deciduous tree has distinctive large, broadly oval pale green leaves. Pollard to enhance the foliage. Beanlike seedpods follow the white summer flowers. Considered weedy outside of native range.

↑50ft (15m) ↔50ft (15m)

☀ Z5–9 (N)



SHRUB LARGE

Chamaerops humilis

EUROPEAN FAN PALM This evergreen palm has fan-shaped, divided green architectural leaves, ideal for foliage schemes. Mature plants bear clusters of small yellow summer flowers. It is more likely to survive winters if grown in free-draining soil.

↑10ft (3m) ↔6ft (2m)

☀ Z8–11